FREE GUIDE · 7-MINUTE READ

The Homeowner's Guide to Storm-Ready Backup Power

Everything Upstate SC homeowners need to know about connecting a portable generator safely and legally.

Inlet box | Interlock kit | Generator connected

Why Your Generator Is Only Half the Solution

You bought a generator. Smart move. But right now it's sitting in your garage waiting for a storm. When that storm hits at 2 AM, what's your actual plan?

Run extension cords through a cracked window? That gets you a fridge and a lamp. Maybe your phone charger. That's it.

> **What extension cords can't power:** Your well pump. Your HVAC. Your sump pump. Anything on a 240-volt circuit.

The real solution: connect your generator directly to your breaker panel through a code-compliant inlet and interlock system. One cord. Full panel access. Done in a morning.

> **You already spent $800 to $2,000 on that generator.** It's 90% of the way there. The inlet and interlock connection is the last piece that makes it actually work the way you imagined when you bought it.

The 3 Ways to Connect a Generator

	Extension Cords	Transfer Switch	Inlet + Interlock
Safety	Dangerous Risk	Safe Good	Safe Good
Power	A few outlets	Pre-selected circuits	Your entire panel
Cost	$0	$3,000 - $5,000	Custom quote
Permit	No	Yes	Yes (we handle it)
Install	None	Full day	One morning
Best For	**Emergencies only**	**Unlimited budget**	**Most homeowners** Best Value

What Actually Happens During an Install

People imagine a huge project. It's not.

1. **Mount the Inlet Box**
   Weatherproof power inlet on your exterior wall, near your panel.

2. **Install the Interlock Kit**
   Mechanical interlock prevents main and generator breakers from both being on.

3. **Wire It Up**
   Heavy-gauge wire from inlet to a dedicated breaker in your panel.

4. **Test + Walkthrough**
   We fire it up and walk you through the whole process.

Inlet box

Interlock

Full install

> **Usually about 4 hours.** Most installs done by lunch.

The Permit Question

"Do I really need a permit?" Yes. And here's why that's a good thing.

- ✓ **Insurance protection.** Unpermitted electrical work can void your claim.
- ✓ **Home resale.** Unpermitted work shows up on inspections.
- ✓ **Safety check.** County inspector confirms everything is right.

> **You don't deal with any of it.** We pull the permit, schedule the inspection, handle the paperwork. All included.

5 Questions to Ask Before You Hire Anyone

1. **Licensed electrical contractor?**
   Not a handyman. Not a GC. A licensed electrician.

2. **All-in price?**
   Materials, labor, permit, inspection, cleanup. No surprises.

3. **They pull the permit?**
   "Pull it yourself" is a red flag.

4. **How many have they done?**
   You want someone who does this regularly.

5. **Guarantee?**
   Code-compliant, county-inspected, workmanship guaranteed.

> **Backup Power Pro answers yes to all five.**

Ready to Get Connected?

Three steps. One morning. Full power for the next storm.

(864) 400-5302

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